User Experience and Usability

ECTS
5
Prerequisites

Main purpose
To introduce students to User eXperience and Usability
Understanding the user is an important part of design. In this course the student gets to dive into the mind and feelings of the user to gain skills in designing better solutions.
Cognition, emotions, authenticity and hedonics are topics within this area. In this journey the key term eXperience is explored in particular within usability, and different kinds of usability tests are conducted e.g. using tools like eye tracking glasses and other neuro sensors.

Knowledge
Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:
- Explain how sensed elements (colors, typography, imagery) evoke emotions
- Explain emotional design using a 3 layer model
- Recognize the significance of usability testing
- Recognize the impact of cognitive load on usability.

Skills
Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:
- Recognize common cognitive processes (e.g., perception, attention, memory).
- Identify cognitive biases that impact user behavior.
- Conduct usability tests with real users using both controlled and natural settings
- Analyse user feedback to improve a design using Instant Data Analysis.
- Discuss the impact of emotional engagement on user behavior.

Competences
Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:
- Compare emotional design across different platforms (web, mobile, physical products)
- Reflect on the impact of authentic storytelling in product narratives
- Propose innovative emotional design solutions for specific contexts
- Reflect on the emotional impact of design choices.
- Compare different settings in usability testing
- Evaluate the impact of design decisions on user satisfaction.
- Discuss ethical considerations in UX design.
- Apply advanced thinking and creativity in understanding the user’s desire and behavior
- Propose innovative solutions for enhancing social interactions in digital products.

Topics
Emotional Design, Cognition, Social Interaction, Authenticity, Hedonics, Interaction Design, Usability testing, Wizard of Oz testing, Instant data analysis

Teaching methods and study activities
Workload for students is estimated to 125 hours – incl. examination and working on a course assignment. 4 lessons per week containing presentations, exercises and practical lab work.

Exam
Exam prerequisites:
None

Type of exam:
Individual oral exam, 20 minutes.
During the semester, the student must prepare one course assignment, which must be submitted in WISEflow prior to the exam.
For the oral exam, the student draws one of the topics from the curriculum, which will be discussed based on the course assignment, but the student may be asked about the full syllabus of the course.
The assessment is based solely on the student's oral performance. Internal assessment.

Tools allowed:
All

Re-exam:
Same as the ordinary exam.

Grading criteria
Grading according to the Danish 7-point scale.

Responsible
Henrik Kronborg Pedersen (hekp)

Valid from
01-08-2024

Course type
Elective for Software Engineering. Elective for the specialization Interactive Media
Valgfag for Softwareingeniør. Valgfag for Interactive Media specialisering.